

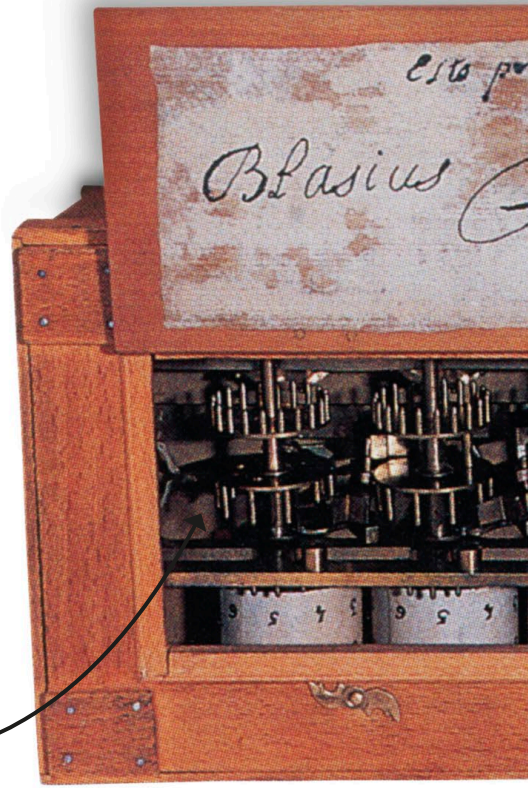
Coding before computers

Even before the invention of the modern computer, people were creating code. Many early programs took the form of cards punched with holes, which represented a set of instructions. These cards were read by machines to perform different tasks.

Pascaline

The Pascaline was invented by French mathematician Blaise Pascal. It was a simple calculating device that could add and subtract.

Sums were calculated by the movement of drums and gears inside the box.



Jacquard loom

This weaving machine was made by Joseph Jacquard. It could weave patterns in fabric by following instructions from cards punched with holes.



FACT FILE

- » **When:** Early 1800s
- » **Function:** Loom
- » **Fun fact:** Fabric patterns today are still created using special computer programs.

Census machine

Herman Hollerith invented this machine to record data for the 1890 US census. It used punched cards to record information such as age and gender.

A clerk would sit at the desk and insert punched cards into the machine.

